

Problem-Solution Fit

Project: Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Phase: 3. Project Design Phase

This document shows that the problem is real, who faces it, and why automating standard laptop orders with Flow Designer fits that problem.

1. Problem Statement

Employees who need a standard laptop raise requests through emails, chats and spreadsheets. Approvals get delayed or lost, procurement re-enters the same data to raise a purchase order, and nobody can see the status. A routine, repeatable purchase takes days and wastes effort for requesters, managers and the procurement team.

2. Problem-Solution Fit Canvas

Element	Description
Customer segments	New joiners and existing employees needing a standard laptop; line managers; Finance approvers; procurement officers; IT asset managers.
Jobs to be done	Get a laptop quickly; approve requests without chasing; raise POs without re-typing; keep assets accurate.
Triggers	New hire onboarding, laptop refresh cycle, damaged or lost device, project expansion.
Problems and pain	Unstructured requests, approval delays, duplicate data entry, no status visibility, no audit trail, budget checked late.
Root causes	No single intake channel, no rules-based routing, disconnected approval and procurement steps.
Current alternatives	Email chains, spreadsheets, verbal requests, manual PO creation.
Emotions (before / after)	Frustrated, uncertain / Confident, informed.
Solution	A Service Catalog item for standard laptops that triggers a Flow Designer flow for approval, PO or procurement task creation, asset update and notification.
Channels	Service Portal / Employee Center, email approvals, ServiceNow mobile.
Behaviour change	Users raise every laptop need through one catalog item and track it online instead of emailing.
Success measures	Faster approval, zero PO re-entry, full audit trail, higher requester satisfaction.

3. Fit Summary

Problem	How the solution addresses it
Requests scattered across channels	One validated catalog form for standard laptops
Slow or lost approvals	Automatic routing, reminders and escalation
Manual PO creation	Request data mapped automatically into the procurement task / PO
No visibility	Status shown in the portal with notifications at each stage
No audit trail	Every approval and state change stored in the request record